farmers has been established. Also, the government has aided in providing mechanical tools, irrigation projects, and improved techniques. But little of this is actual socialism—the economic system of India is only partly socialistic—but, rather, development in the direction of social welfare for all the people. The so-called socialistic program of India's economic life does not deny individual opportunity, individual wealth, or individualistic economic justice, and is not in any way connected with any political ideology of an anti-individualistic nature.

The reforms that have been made have been directed against a lack of a sense of social welfare or social responsibility in India, and they do not have any destructive effect whatsoever upon the opportunity, the freedom of choice, or the right of economic pursuit by individuals. There has been some socialization or nationalization of industries which are vital to the country as a whole, but this has been indispensable in view of the unscrupulous attitudes and practices of many of the big industrialists and manufacturers and in the interest of social and economic justice for all.

These reforms have been based largely upon practical concerns. These economic and social monistic tendencies do not really find their bases in an alleged philosophical monism such as the Advaita Vedānta, which is only one extreme philosophical point of view and not typical of Indian metaphysics or any other Indian philosophical schools, as some are inclined to think.

CONCLUSION

Given the brief survey of the social ideas and practices of the Indians spreading over a three-age period of about three thousand years, the conclusions are three:

1. India has a glorious tradition of respect, freedom, and dignity of the individual, and the individual in relation to society—as glorious as any country has today. This ancient tradition of India was, of course, never purely individualistic. This was because of the religious and moral teachings of the Hindus and Buddhists, that the highest destiny of the individual lies in the perfection of his individuality in a way which inevitably takes him outside his narrow egoism and brings him fulfillment in relation to the society in which he lives. That is one reason why Hindu social structure provided for deep sanctity of social institutions such as the family, the school, the *varṇas,* and the four stages of life.

2. In Indian society the main concepts which governed the in-